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COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Digital Solutions Leader at Hitachi Digital Services Sees Ema as Top Choice for Enterprise AI Workflow Automation

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
25 May 2026	24 Feb 2026	Customer	Investor-Led (Buy-Side)	EMA.CO

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The interview covered the adoption, implementation, and evaluation of an AI-driven workflow automation platform for enterprise use cases in sales, HR, and operations. Discussion included use case details, KPIs, customization, integration, vendor selection, and future internal capability development.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Digital Solutions Leader with experience implementing AI-driven workflow automation and agentic platforms for enterprise clients, focusing on sales, HR, and operations use cases.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- **The expert is highly satisfied with Ema for enterprise-grade, horizontal automation across multiple business functions, citing rapid time-to-value and robust orchestration as key strengths**.
- **The expert feels confident in their organization's ability** to now build similar workflows internally, having learned from the Ema implementation, and expects future spend on Ema to remain stable or grow only slightly.
- While Ema is not a lightweight, plug-and-play tool, the expert values its enterprise capabilities and would rate it a 10/10 for organizations seeking comprehensive, scalable solutions.

TAKEAWAYS

- The primary business problem addressed was reducing manual, cross-system processes and cycle times in sales, HR, and operations through AI-driven automation.
- Four main use cases were implemented: automated research and synthesis for sales, workflow automation for HR, content drafting and QA for sales enablement, and context-aware knowledge retrieval and summarization.
- **Key KPIs tracked included cycle time reduction (achieving 40-60% improvement), reduction in human touchpoints (up to 80%), increased throughput per employee,** and cost per case.
- Ema's platform provided a library of customizable AI agents, with workflows built around user-defined triggers and parallel agent execution, supported by initial vendor hand-holding and then internal team ownership.
- The expert evaluated several competitors (ServiceNow AI Agents, OpenAI Frontier, UiPath, Copilot, IBM watsonx Orchestrate) but chose Ema for its enterprise-grade governance, horizontal applicability, and faster deployment; pricing was subscription-based and not consumption-driven.

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Expert Bio

Digital Solutions Leader at Hitachi Digital Services. The expert can speak to use-cases, adoption experience, and spending patterns as a global customer of Ema. Digital Solutions Leader at Hitachi Digital Services. The expert is responsible for initiatives that integrate data, cloud, AI, and industrial IoT to drive innovation, operational efficiency, and sustainable growth. Former Worldwide Technical Lead for Industry Partners Internet of Things at Amazon Web Services, leaving in December 2024. The expert is responsible for setting AWS's global partner strategy to accelerate growth in targeted industries. leads the technical enablement of the global strategic Partners in IoT. responsible for architectural guidance, GTM strategies, influencing roadmap, and driving IoT initiatives for the Partners. Works with Industrial IoT (IIoT) Partners for their platform integration with AWS IoT and to build repeatable and scalable solutions for customers across multiple verticals like Industrial IoT, Oil&Gas, bio-pharmaceutical etc.

Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

Thanks for taking the call. We can quickly get started. I'll set context for today's discussion. Broadly, what we're trying to understand is more about how you use Ema, what was the business context, and the problem statement for which you adopted it, what are the use cases that are live with you, what other products did you evaluate, and so forth. Good point to start would be if you can describe to us the business context and the problem statement that you were trying to solve which led you to adopt Ema, and then we can go from there.

Expert 00:00:34

Absolutely. When we look at the use cases or the problem statements given to us, it was on a high level about four different ways. They belong to four different categories. One was strategy and sales support. The second one was HR and operations support at a high level. Third one also falls into the sales and strategy support, but more on the enablement side, so sales enablement.

Finally, the fourth one was retrieval and summarization of knowledge from existing datasets. These are the four categories of different solutions or use cases that were acting as the problem statements when this customer approached us.

On the sales and strategy, it was about automated research and synthesis of data. Internal data was given, external signals from customers were given in this area. The goal was to have an agentic approach or agent-driven synthesis to execute ready summaries, if that made sense to you. This will be used by sales strategists and their leadership teams to evaluate. That's on the first use case. Any questions on that?

Client 00:01:45

Before getting into the use cases, maybe it'll be helpful to zoom out and if you could talk about what was the business problem statement that was trying to be solved with these four use cases. Maybe for example, that can be more productivity, **that can be cost reduction through AI tools** that you might want to implement, but would be helpful if we zoom out and start from there, and then we can come to the use cases.

Expert 00:02:09

Sure. Like I said, on a high level, this was go-to-market support to start with. First one was go-to-market support. That was where the first use case that I mentioned about looked into. From the go-to-market support, how do I say, there was critical work that is trapped in manual cross-systems processes, how can we leverage an agentic approach for data spanning multiple systems and teams that requires human coordination, that requires copy-paste of work, that has lot of tribal knowledge **that is impacting their flow cycle times**, high operational costs? These were what this customer on a whiteboard put as their pain points.

The clear pain point from the customer was derived in the discussion from this customer, if it made sense to you. Their workflows included sales research, HR operations, customer resolutions, compliance, etc. The exact pain point of the customer was not derived from the customer directly. These were patches of data given to us, and we have to come up with the exact pain point, spoke to the customer, if this is what they want. They said yes, and that's when we leveraged Ema to solve that pain point. Did that make sense to you at a high level?

Client 00:03:25

Got it. All of these use cases that you implemented with Ema were not implemented internally. It was all implemented for your customers. Is that the right understanding?

Expert 00:03:36

Here's the point. When you say internally, we had customers in house. If you look at Hitachi, it's a conglomerate. We were technology partners for them.

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Client 00:03:48

Got it. Maybe if I were to phrase the question differently, were you tracking any KPIs that measured the success of your implementation? That will help us understand the nature of the problem statement that you were trying to solve better.

Expert 00:04:04

Good question. The primary KPI here was cycle time reduction. Time taken to complete an end-to-end task, that was the KPI. Here, we were tracking three different ones. One was support case, if there is a case opened, what time it took to close it, the closure, then when there was an HR request, how long was **it taking to resolve it**, the resolution time.

Finally, sales research. This was helping the account briefing team. Account briefs are provided based on the documentation. Three or four different cycle time reductions were the KPIs. The goal **we achieved was about 40%-60% reduction cycle time**. That was the first one.

The second KPI that we took was how many touchpoints per workflow did we look into? Baseline was there were about 10-12 touchpoints to solve a pain point. This includes emails, approvals, reviews, etc. We wanted to reduce that. 50%-60% reduction was the goal.

Client 00:05:09

Sorry, just one clarification there. What is the touchpoint, and why does it matter that you're increasing the number of touchpoints for workflows?

Expert 00:05:20

If you look at human interventions, you don't want lot of interventions for a pain point or a request.

Client 00:05:27

A human touchpoint, got it.

Expert 00:05:29

That was the manual touchpoint. You want to reduce it as much as possible. Now from 10-12, If you could reduce by 80%, that's amazing. Within two requests, within two touchpoints, it's resolved. That's the goal. The third KPI that we were taking was per employee what was the throughput, so how much output a team can produce without adding any headcount? Now this could be HR tickets resolved, content draft reviewed, per sales enablement leads, accounts researched per seller, per use case. Again, we were trying to increase the throughput by 50% in some cases, 100% in some cases. That was for capacity creation. That's the third one.

We also looked at cost per case, so cost per HR request, cost per support ticket, cost per sales opportunity, research. Cost, that's the other one. We also look at time to value for new use cases. Again, when we started, we started with four typical KPIs, but then over time, we looked at adoption across role teams as another KPI because this is an internal/external. Internal goals also evolve with this, what was knowledge reuse rate, adoption across role teams, governance, and risk KPIs. All of these were KPIs.

Client 00:06:55

Got it. I understand the primary, secondary, tertiary KPIs to use. That's helpful. How many use cases would you say you considered making live when you considered these KPIs, and how many use cases are live as of now?

Expert 00:07:13

We looked at, I believe, three or four use cases typically. Let me think through for a second, please. I think four three or four. We started with four. The first one was automated research and synthesis. I think I mentioned this earlier as well, then we had a workflow automation which is internal for their HR teams.

You're looking at content drafting and QA support for customer-facing documents and content which is sales enablement, third one. Finally, we were looking at context-aware retrieval, not keyword-based. It was context-aware-based knowledge retrieval and summarization for their internal documents. These were, I think, four. Did I mention four?

Client 00:08:00

Got it. Which would you say is the largest use case that is live for you?

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Expert 00:08:06

All of these four use cases were live. They were all implemented for different teams. Different requirements were there. For example, knowledge retrieval and summarization would look a simple use case, but **it has more hits** as compared to automated research and synthesis because for sales and strategy, unless you have a customer, you don't use this use case.

Knowledge retrieval and summarization, your employees request your HR tools pretty often. Even, for example, when is the next holiday could be a search. **It is difficult to pinpoint** exactly whether it's a simple search or whether it's context-aware retrieval search as a KPI at this point.

Client 00:08:47

I understand that. My objective in asking the question is I just want to pick one of these use cases. If you can walk us through it end to end, how it was being solved before, and once you introduce Ema, what is the new process to solve it, that will help us understand that use case better. I just wanted to understand which is the largest use case that is live for you. We can pick that and walk through it end to end.

Expert 00:09:15

Understood. Thanks for the clarity here. Agent-driven knowledge retrieval and summarization is the largest use case, in my opinion. Happy to walk through that approach.

Client 00:09:26

Got it. How do you measure largest use case here? Is it simply by consumption because you have more employees using this particular product?

Expert 00:09:37

That is correct.

Client 00:09:38

Got it. Which would be the most customer-facing product in your opinion?

Expert 00:09:44

The first one that I mentioned earlier, which was document summarization, creating sales content strategy.

Client 00:09:50

Got it. Why don't we actually pick that and let's walk through that?

Expert 00:09:55

Okay. If you look at this particular one, what we've done is the context given to us were there were sales and strategy teams that were looking for up-to-date intelligence, high-quality intelligence on accounts, marketing, competitor information, deals currently happening internally, strategic initiatives, etc. This information is distributed across. If you look at the sources, it includes CRM documents, emails, call summaries, external sources, etc. This was the essential data points given to us.

When we looked at Ema and implemented an agent-owned workflow here, the primary internal goal was not to have a report or a dashboard, but an agent and a workflow from it. The architecture that we implemented was when a user or a CRM or a schedule was triggered, a research-planning agent gets triggered.

Client 00:10:47

Sorry to interrupt, but what would be helpful is if you can walk through the process before Ema was introduced. I understand there's a lot of this high-quality information and signals that lies in discrete systems that are not connected to each other. What would the process be for a sales and strategy team to now collect and synthesize information, how would they use it, so we understand the basic context, and then you can tell us how Ema was used.

Expert 00:11:13

Okay. Before the automated research and synthesis for sales and strategy was there, it was human orchestrated across many systems, either a seller would start with a request which was account brief or competitive view, etc. This manually pulled context from multiple places,

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good CRM, support tooling, document, etc. This was extremely painful because no one knows what is the single source of truth here. Again, data was very scattered. Every brief was built from scratch here. To retrieve the data, a lot of time was spent and then analyzing that data. These were first degree pain points.

The second point was if you look at the retrieval of data itself, it was search-first, not intent-based. People use keywords in SharePoint or whatever sources of data, Drive, or their Teams and Slack and it was exported snippets into a document.

From there, CRM notes were basically inconsistent here. If you look at external searches as well, it's very ad hoc. All of this data here was search-first, which means output was very skewed and it was towards what was easiest to find, not was most important. That categorization was not there. Very critically, **important signals, for example, unresolved escalations and renewal frictions and contract clauses**, all of this information was missing, which was very important. It was not intent-based first. That was the second one.

If you look at the review itself, the view was based on enablement strategy leads and managers, etc. It includes common failure modes which is missing critical facts, what is happening on a contract, who are the key stakeholder changes, competitive presence was missed. All of these were how it was done before Ema.

Client 00:13:09

Got it. Sorry, just quickly to finish this point, the output of this is a report that is collated and then reviewed the seller, whoever is initiating this request?

Expert 00:13:21

That is correct. In simplified way, before Ema, both research synthesis documentation was very manual. It consists of multi-systems and very inconsistent. Collecting and reconciling information took the most amount of time. These were not in a structured way. These were the critical pain points if you could highlight for that particular use case. This is where we brought in Ema.

I think the next step would be how it's implemented. Look at the step-by-step implementation of Ema. The first one was what are triggers and what is the context set up here? We defined the triggers in this use case, so what's the seller request, what is an event of CRM, opportunity stage change, then what are calendar events, the meetings that you set up with this, what is the scheduled run, strategic briefs, etc. These were trigger points.

We also injected the context of each role here, so what is the role, whether it's a seller role, sales leader, executive role, etc. For each role, we also define the objective, whether it's an opportunity, whether it's an account, and then on objective, which is very important here, which is you're trying to close a deal, whether you're trying to renew a deal, or assess risk here or inform the different strategy here for the customer, etc. That's all the objective. Outputs are purpose-built and in this particular case with Ema.

Once the trigger and context were set up, the second stage was task decomposition and also research planning. I'll start with research planning here which is an agentic approach. If you look at a research planning agent here, the objective is interpreted first point and then research threads. It breaks it down into research threads.

Once it's broken down, each thread to a specialized agent is given. If you look at how this works, a simplistic example would be one request could be, "Give me a strategic account brief for a particular account before it gets renewed." That is the kind of search.

This will decompose into automatic history of the account, what is the engagement type, what is the deal and pipeline signals here, what is the competitive landscape here, what are external business signals? Could be the news, could be leadership changes, could be the funding, could be Series A, whatever, all that level. That second stage.

You look at agent based parallel execution where Ema here runs multiple research agents in parallel. These agents could be both internal research agents or external agents on the research side. On the internal side, very simply, these are CRM, deal support, usage, document conversion, conversation. These are all internal research agents in a way.

You also consider external agents like news and market intelligence, competitor agents, signals from companies. These include external research agents. Each agent here will retrieve only authorized data. I think that's very critical here. It returns findings in a structured way and not just a dump. Hope that made sense.

Finally, we have signal extraction and normalization where raw findings are converted into decision-oriented signals. We have strategic synthesis and reasoning on top of it. Finally, we have model orchestration. These are five, six steps that with the help of Ema, we've curated the solution.

Client 00:17:02

Got it. At the end of these three steps, you create the same output report that is viewed by the seller. Is that the right understanding?

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Expert 00:17:12

That is correct, but then we also come up with validation risk and confidence scoring of what we've. Before delivery, a validation agent will check here. It'll check source, coverage gaps, if there's anything missing there, missing signals, conflicting data. This is very important to prove to the customer that **we've not missed** out and we've carried out this in a thorough way. On top of that, a human review can also be done here to verify everything is done. That's how we've approached this part.

Client 00:17:42

Got it. Across these three steps, can you tell me exactly what Ema helps you do? I understood the three steps that you follow to create the output, but what are all the things that Ema needs to do to create that output? To give you an example of how I'm thinking about this, for example, there would be a lot of integrations that are required with multiple CRM tools, email, Slack, customer support tools, etc.

Did all of that come pre-built with Ema? Did you have any systems where they build custom integrations for you? After that, what does the interface look like where you're building these agents? How do you build an agent? Does that come pre-built with Ema, or do you customize anything inside Ema? If can you walk through those steps sequentially, that will be helpful.

Expert 00:18:33

It's a very loaded question. I hope I remember everything, but I'll try to answer. The first thing, what Ema does is it turned unstructured requests into a workflow. Before Ema came into the picture, every request was interpreted differently by each person. Where Ema helped here is it has something called GWE, a Generative Workflow Engine, which feeds in high-level requests into explicit subtasks. That is the first step Ema does.

The second thing it does is it helps you integrate, if not thousands, hundreds of applications so an agent can pull context from many systems. That was the second task of Ema. What it does is Ema's platform is emphasizing, should I say, enterprise-grade security and trust with the help of the GWE that I mentioned before, the workflow engine. It also has high-quality synthesis via EmaFusion which is for multimodal routing. It also has governed data-handling approach, and then it has both repeatable artifacts and system updates.

Client 00:19:36

I didn't understand some of what you said, but maybe I'll just rephrase my question. In the example workflow that you walked us through, where you first define triggers and context, and then there is task decomposition, research planning, and then the signal is extracted and then you synthesize it.

Maybe just in that workflow itself, you can describe to me exactly what are the different things that Ema does. For example, first, how do you define a trigger and a context? Is this a framework that's provided by Ema or is this a subjective thing that you write inside Ema as a prompt or it is built for you, for Hitachi? How exactly does that work?

You can move on to the next step and say, "Okay, for the agent approach, Ema provides me an agent, or I'm able to create an agent inside Ema and dedicate that to a specific task, how exactly does that work." I lost you in some of those jargon or keywords that you mentioned.

Expert 00:20:37

No problem. Let me come up with an architecture first. It's a six-step architecture. First one is a trigger. From the trigger, you have a research-planning agent that comes with Ema. The trigger is not what Ema provides. Trigger is what the user provides, a seller request, or an event from CRM, etc. It's an automated workflow. You have a research-planning agent that's from Ema. From the research planning, you have parallel research agents, both internal and external. One looks at internal data. One looks at external data. That provided by Ema.

Client 00:21:17

Sorry, just to clarify, the trigger is provided by the user, but the capability to define the trigger is a necessary step inside Ema?

Expert 00:21:28

Correct. That's where you define what is the role, object, and objective. Ema helps you inject that.

Client 00:21:36

Got it. Every such workflow that you build inside Ema will necessarily have a trigger?

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Expert 00:21:41
That is correct.

Client 00:21:42
Got it. You said Ema provides a research-planning agent. Does this mean it provides you a library of agents, and then you choose one of them, or do you create a research-planning agent?

Expert 00:21:55
No, it provides a library where you customize it based on your use case.

Client 00:22:01
Can you help us understand how exactly does that work? What does this library of agents look like? What are the different types of agents that are provided? How do you customize an agent?

Expert 00:22:13
If you look at the research planning agent, it helps it interpret the objective, and then it helps you create threads. Each thread can be assigned to a specialized agent. That's the library I'm talking about. There are a lot of specialized agents doing each tasks, and then your objective is broken down into threads. That thread gets assigned into specialized agent.

Client 00:22:37
Got it. Can you give me other examples of agents in this library? One can be a research planning agent. What are others?

Expert 00:22:47
One could be deal and pipeline signals. One could be support and escalation, product usage indicators. These are all AI agents.

Client 00:22:58
Understood. Do you get to choose which agent you want to perform a specific task, or is that chosen based on the thread that is identified by Ema?

Expert 00:23:08
Both. There is a trigger available there whether you can choose what you want to define or you can say, "Ema, choose for me," based on the inputs that you provide.

Client 00:23:19
Understood. If I understand correctly, you are providing a trigger, and based on the trigger, you get some information. That information is broken down. Sorry, what was the word that you mentioned for this?

Expert 00:23:32
Research thread.

Client 00:23:34
Different research threads, and then you have a choice depending on the thread, whether Ema calls the agent or whether you call the agent.

Expert 00:23:42
Correct. Each thread gets assigned to a specialized agent here based on what you're trying to achieve. This is what the research planning agent did.

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Client 00:23:51

Got it. How do you choose which specialized agent you would want to call if you don't know what is the thread that Ema is going to identify based on the trigger?

Expert 00:24:01

Okay. This is where either an SME can help or if you don't have an SME that you do want to trust him or her, then you depend on the research-planning agents to autonomously pick itself. You can provide some inputs to it, some basic knowledge based on what you think it should do, and it will pick up for you. This is the customization I was talking about.

Client 00:24:24

Got it. You can either give your inputs, or you can say, "Ema, this is what I want to achieve as triggers," and it will pick up for you. How many such specialized agents are pre-created inside Ema?

Expert 00:24:38

Good question. It's a library. I haven't exactly checked the depth of it, but it's quite intense.

Client 00:24:46

Would this be, say, below 50, above 50, if you have to ballpark it?

Expert 00:24:51

Yeah. It's in the range of hundreds at least because they were paid in the range of hundreds.

Client 00:24:58

Understood. In a typical workflow for you, how many specialized agents would you be using?

Expert 00:25:04

In this particular case, like I said, in the architecture itself, one use case is for research planning that we just discussed. You have in the process parallel research, both internal and external. That's two more. You have strategy and synthesis agent, another one. You have validation and risk agent. Totally, you have five to six use cases on a simplistic approach, but then you can make it complex. You can create an agent for an agent. It's up to you how you want to do it. Usually, stateful agents are about five to six for this use case.

Client 00:25:45

Got it. The extent of customization available is depending on the threat identified. You can choose which type of specialized agent is being called, or you can leave that decision up to Ema. Within each specialization, can you customize it anymore, or is it just an out-of-the-box agent specialized agent that you use?

Expert 00:26:07

These agents can be customized, and typically, most of the time there is a big chance that **you might miss out some of the parallel trends** here. For all the use cases we have used, we've used Ema Generator Workflow Engine. That will take care of all the agents for you.

Client 00:26:24

What is the additional customization that you said is available?

Expert 00:26:28

Like I said, for example, in the research-planning phase, you can talk about, "Hey, I want to provide product usage indicators." You can feed in your input. If you don't know the input, you can say, "Hey, I don't know the input here. Let the Generator Workflow Engine create the agent for me through Ema." You can feed in saying, "Consider these inputs, consider inputs like product usage, consider competitive."

Client 00:26:55

The end goal of this customization is just choosing which type of agent you want to use because the input helps you choose that, but is there an additional next step? Also, after choosing the specialized agent, is there additional customization that you do for that specialized

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agent?

Expert 00:27:12
No. Once you choose the agent, the agent gets attached to research planning and task decomposition stage.

Client 00:27:19
Got it. Basically, if I were to put it another way, the broad capabilities of what you can do with Ema is then in some sense restricted by the number of specialized agents that they have available to you, but you're saying that's in the hundred, so it's a very large number of specialized agents.

Expert 00:27:36
Right. It's always in progress. Currently it's 100. Tomorrow, it could be 105. It's work in progress based on the use cases that's available in the market, what their customers are presenting as request, etc. It's a work in progress, always.

Client 00:27:58
Understood. All of the use cases that you had live for you, were you building these use cases yourself inside Ema, or did Ema have a team that work with your team in order to build these use cases out for you?

Expert 00:28:10
In the initial days, **we had a little difficulty** understanding Ema and its approaches. We did have some SLAs with them to support us from a POV standpoint. Until that was achieved, we had hand-holding from that team initial days, but once we understood clearly how these agents worked and all, we were able to run ourselves.

Client 00:28:33
What was the nature of the hand-holding from their team? Was this integrating all your systems into Ema? Was that what they did, or were they coaching you in how to build an agent inside Ema?

Expert 00:28:44
Both. The first one for both.

Client 00:28:49
Understood. How long was this hand-holding period where they were helping you with integration, then they were helping you with coaching, etc. ?

Expert 00:28:59
I would say for the first use case, it was about three to four days. From the second one, it's usually a day, a few hours finally. Once we ran two use cases from the third use case, we just had a 30-minutes to 45-minutes session to say that "Hey, this is what we approach. Are we following the best practices for Ema?" One or two minor modifications were adjusted. For the fourth use case, we didn't need any help from them. We were getting comfortable. Usually, it's overall maybe a week of hand-holding for all the use cases.

Client 00:29:33
Got it. Did they integrate all of your tools with Ema, or did they teach you how to do it and then you integrated all of them?

Expert 00:29:40
They taught us and we integrated ourselves.

Client 00:29:43
Got it. For these four use cases that you mentioned, how many integrations would you have done?

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Expert 00:29:49

Here's the point. We were trying at other players and other vendors too, so we knew in order to achieve that, we had to bring our data together. All our datasets were readily available. Integrations were number of data points. These agents were going and picking up our data sources directly. These were API-based. We had all of the data readily available.

We started with the POV, remember? For the first time, we tried with six or seven random datasets to see if the integration actually works. Overall, we had about 15-17 data sources, CRM agents, and deal agents and support agents, usage agents. For each agent, we had a combination of four or five different data sources to bring value.

Client 00:30:40

Got it. It sounds like in your specific case, you had a point of view on which specialized agents you wanted to be called because in some sense, you were also choosing your data sets based on that. Did you have that point of view in the beginning?

Expert 00:30:58

We did because we were looking at other vendors, like I said, we were looking at a few players or we were also seeing shall we implement it ourselves? We were looking at some possible competitors in the market before Ema came. While understanding each of these competitors, we felt that this is the approach we need to take. We did some groundwork for these four use cases because we know **we were also looking at scaling win**, not just POV. This was not an experiment for us. We knew we want to achieve this. We were very clear on what we want as an encode.

Client 00:31:34

Got it. I'll just come back to which other products you evaluated a bit later, but just to close this part out, it seems like there were a specific number of datasets that you wanted. You had a point of view on specialized agents that you wanted to integrate. You also built those integrations, but after that, it is dependent, like you said, on this library that Ema makes available for you.

At any point, did you feel like you wanted more customization, but you were restricted by the number of agents that Ema provided for you, or was it the case that it all worked perfectly and there was no additional customization needed at all?

Expert 00:32:11

Before the use cases that we had, at least what we heard from Ema's team was that these are very common use cases for them, what we're trying to achieve. The only difference was we had a lot of scale. A lot of customers have tried them under POC and POV for them, so they knew exactly what the workflows were and all. They were prepared for this.

The only thing that they were not prepared was our scaling because we as a company, we had different set of documents and approaches for each of the company within our organization, which means **scaling was the biggest concern** that Ema's team felt we would face. They came supporting to help us out for us.

Client 00:32:52

What does that mean that they help you with scaling?

Expert 00:32:56

Most customers would start with POC and that's where **they would evaluate, but our concern** was, look, we would come with a POV, yes, but we want to try it out in different organizations with different bounding rules. Organization A and organization B were both part of the parent organization here for us. Some of the rules and some of the documents, some of the search criteria, and approaches would change. Even for HR, organization A would have holiday on day one. That is the scaling approach we're looking at.

Client 00:33:29

Got it. When you say scaling, what you really mean is across organization A and B, the way that you store data, the way that you process data, maybe the places that you store data as well, they're all different from each other, so you won't be able to transfer whatever you've built for organization A directly onto organization B. In some sense, it's not very generalized. That's what you mean?

Expert 00:33:54

That is correct.

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Client 00:33:56

Got it. What was the nature of the help that Ema provided you to generalize this? Did they come in with customization for each specific "scalability problem" that you encountered?

Expert 00:34:08

Not directly, as you said, but they give us pointers on how to approach this from extending the use case from org A to org B. How would the agents fetch the data, what could be the trigger points for them, those things are what Ema gave us as pointers and best practices, which was very simple because they've tried this. They've done this for other customers too.

On first go itself, we were able to understand what they were trying to do. They're trying to help this out. I think in one of the instances, they showed us a couple of demos for a generic customer of theirs, how they've done it. We've simply adopted that and it worked for us.

Client 00:34:47

Got it. This was more of a consultative approach. It was your internal team that then took this advice and implemented it?

Expert 00:34:56

That is correct.

Client 00:34:58

Understood. How large a team do you have internally that has been trained to work with Ema?

Expert 00:35:05

About 14-16 folks on this particular one.

Client 00:35:08

Got it. Is that number constant? As you scale the number of use cases across your org, do you also need to scale the number of people who are more comfortable using the platform, or is this team of 16, you find it sufficient to use Ema and deploy newer use cases as well?

Expert 00:35:26

Yeah. I think with the Ema team support initially, 14, 16 people plus another four, six people from Ema team that were helping us with different segments, that was sufficient for us to scale. It was a few months project. I think six months we scaled them out. We didn't need any more folks. This was enough for us. This was dedicated team for Ema.

Client 00:35:52

Got it. Earlier you mentioned that you were also considering other vendors, and in that process, you were also thinking of implementing something internally yourself. Can you talk us through how you considered that decision and how you thought about building internally versus purchasing products that could solve this for you?

Expert 00:36:10

Again, we look at the company organization. We are a digital company as well and we understand our requirements better than anybody else. That's very given. Whether it's sales approach or HR requests, the nature of requests come internally. We knew our requests can be handled internally. At least so far, we were doing it.

When it came to having an agent, AI, and enterprise automation approach, when we understood what use cases we want to achieve and when we were looking at architectures on how to implement it in house, what we thought was we did have the best practices of achieving this, neither we have experience in doing so. We thought, "Let's try for a small POV or a POC understanding how this can be applied or achieved."

While doing so, **one concern** we had was yes, you apply for one organization, you can try it, but when we want to take it to enterprise agentic approach or having an AI platform across the enterprise for different organizations, whether making it horizontal, whether making it autonomous AI for employees, and having an end-to-end workflow, we didn't have a lot of expertise at that point, neither we had a say on what were the best practices, what was the logic to drive the LLMs here for automation, what was the collaboration for building multi-agents. These were something that we didn't have a lot of knowledge on at that point.

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Talking about 16 months ago, 15 months ago. That's when we've approached different vendors, different platforms in the market. We understood what were the core focus of each of these, and overall, when we match it to our requirements, the biggest requirement we had, it was an enterprise-based platform. It has to be horizontal in nature and it has to have end-to-end workflows for AI employees for autonomous use cases.

These were some of the core focuses and primary categories that we were looking, and Ema fell into that bucket clearly amongst the other vendors that we looked at. We went with them for the POV. We liked what we saw, and then we implemented it.

Client 00:38:19

Got it. Hypothetically, if you were considering to build this internally and hypothetically assume that the decision was that you did have the best practices in order to build this, what tools would you have used to build it? Would this be something like CrewAI, LangChain, etc. ?

Expert 00:38:37

CrewAI could be one, Decagon could be another one, Verse.ai, these are other platforms that we could consider, but then you could create your own data layer and agents on top of it, a virtual data player, and create an agent **that could crawl information from different data sources**. That is possible today.

Today, for other use cases, we don't depend on Ema. Ema is there. We've developed it. We deployed it. It's running, working fine. Any other use cases that we are currently doing, we don't go back to Ema because we understood what it takes to build an enterprise agentic platform. We've understood what the horizontal approach here means. We have understood how to make it better based on our knowledge and our organization's case, what we are known for.

We have assets more than anybody in the world, so we know exactly what is the domain knowledge here. We know exactly what the tribal knowledge is. We are leveraging that to build use cases for our customers today. We made it domain-centric as well.

Client 00:39:47

Got it. You mentioned that you've deployed Ema, but you've also used some of this for other tools that you've built internally. Can you just give us some examples of what types of tools these are and what sort of products you've used to build these tools?

Expert 00:40:01

Could you repeat the question again? Sorry.

Client 00:40:05

You mentioned earlier that Ema is something that you've bought a product and you've deployed live, but you also have other use cases that you've built internally. If you can give us an example of what these use cases are and what sort of tools that have, you used to build those use cases, and that can be something like LangChain, that can be something like Verse, you mentioned, or CrewAI, that will be helpful.

Expert 00:40:30

Absolutely. To start with, having an open-source approach is something that we believe strongly in the organization. Now keeping that in mind, the use cases we are looking at was bringing asset intelligence on AI-based asset intelligence.

Say, for example, you have a motor and you want to know when will that motor die or etc. Now we have a synthetic data, we have live data, we have physics-based models, all of that together covering the model that you are building on AI. For that, we've leveraged an agentic framework from CrewAI by building multi-agent collaboration, which is an open-source approach here. That is something that we considered for some of these use cases.

Client 00:41:16

Got it. Within Hitachi, would you say that if you consider open-source use cases like this **that are built, would that far outweigh any external tools like Ema** that you use?

Expert 00:41:27

Again, I started this discussion a few minutes ago saying we have some internal knowledge, tribal knowledge, asset knowledge that we are comfortable leveraging. For the use cases that we leveraged Ema for HR and all, we didn't have that knowledge in house or tribal knowledge. Some extent, yes, but to the other extent, we did not. For that, we are happy to leverage a tool instead of reinventing the wheel. For use cases where we believe we are the domain experts, we want to run it ourselves.

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Client 00:41:59

Got it. Also curious, would there be any software vendors and say that can be something like a Salesforce that would be able to do the sales automation use case that you described to us with Ema off the shelf? Maybe a CRM vendor that also gives you an agent offering and you adopt it and because it already has a lot of these integrations in place, you can start using it. Did you come across anything like that?

Expert 00:42:24

Yes, we had ServiceNow AI Agents, we have OpenAI Frontier, UiPath, if I remember correctly. You also have Copilot to an extent that can do this through Dynamics 365 and Fabric, IBM watsonx Orchestrate. These are some things that were there, but again, they were not very domain-specific to the use case we were looking at. They were more generic in nature. Were the enterprise-grade governance from the start? Don't know.

Ema provided that comfort that we were looking at. True agentic autonomy, agnostic orchestration was provided. Faster time-to-value was big thing from Ema because it took us very short time to actually prove. I was talking about this enterprise-grade governance and then applicability through horizontal approaches, whether it's GTM, HR, and operations and then support. These were some things that made us choose Ema over the Microsoft and UiPath and ServiceNow AI Agents and an OpenAI Frontier, which are, again, direct competitors in a way, but we were comfortable with Ema at some point.

Client 00:43:25

What would the delta be in the KPIs that you were measuring? You mentioned, for example, cycle time reduction, the number of human touchpoints for workflow that you reduce, etc. Some of these platforms are more horizontal and not domain-specific. What is the implication on the KPIs that you are mentioning?

Expert 00:43:46

Implication of using the other vendors?

Client 00:43:49

Correct.

Expert 00:43:51

Like I said, we were not in a stage of KPIs yet with those vendors because what we saw from Ema, time-to-value, having it horizontal, faster orchestration, these were some things that were proven even before the KPIs came for those use cases. You go to KPIs after you deploy a use case certainly, but here, we were looking at where to deploy first and Ema provided that platform for us even before comparing other vendors. We studied other vendors. At some point, **we lost faith in a few of them**.

Client 00:44:24

What was the criteria then? If it wasn't these KPIs, what was the criteria that you used to evaluate Ema with these other vendors?

Expert 00:44:34

Like I said, orchestration, time-to-value, how long it takes to integrate with certain things, domain expertise, how good are these agents as compared to a CRM-based from OpenAI or somebody. These are very use case or vertical-specific. We were looking at a single platform that can apply for HR and sales, etc.

Client 00:44:54

Got it. How long would it have taken to implement some of these other agents that you mentioned, ServiceNow, UiPath, OpenAI Frontier, vs Ema?

Expert 00:45:04

If it comes to those players, we would have said, "We could have built it ourselves." We've estimated it would take us approximately 12-months' to 14-months' time to come up with an enterprise-grade approach like what Ema is providing.

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Client 00:45:18
Sorry, are you saying that for some of these agents, you need 12-14 months to integrate it?

Expert 00:45:23
No, not the agents. We're talking about enterprise level to have a product like Ema that we could take to market to another customer, 12-14 months.

Client 00:45:34
No, I know that that's for building it in house, but you mentioned the time-to-value was the criteria that you use to differentiate between Ema and some of these other players that you mentioned. What would be the delta there if you had to adopt any?

Expert 00:45:49
Understood. Sorry, my bad. Their time-to-value was a few weeks comparatively.

Client 00:45:56
Got it. For Ema, that was one week?

Expert 00:46:00
Once we agreed to it, it was a week.

Client 00:46:02
Got it. Because you haven't yet tested efficacy of these products, you have not yet measured these KPIs because you have not selected the use cases yet, would one week versus three or four weeks create a significant delta in choosing which product you wanted to adopt because it's a long-term decision that you're making?

Expert 00:46:23
Yes, you're right, but that's not the only point. We also spoke about whether it's a horizontal approach or not, that's one. Whether it's an enterprise support or not, that's the second thing. We haven't seen from those vendors on having similar solution in a conglomerate, org A versus org B, how efficiently would be able to pull the data from different data sources, that demos we haven't seen from these vendors.

We've asked them during our initial research phase to show us demos and how it's done. We were given bits and pieces of information but not very concrete detailed of how it's done. They were not able to prove their product to the liking of us. That's another reason why we went with Ema. Ema hit the nail on the first go. We said, "This is our request. Show us what you've got," and they showed us.

Client 00:47:18
Got it. Apart from these competitors that you mentioned, was there anyone else that you also looked at?

Expert 00:47:25
No. I think I've given five or six names. Those were the guys.

Client 00:47:31
Got it. What would your annual ballpark spend be with Ema currently? I understand from your screening responses that you've been using it approximately for a year.

Expert 00:47:42
Right, a few hundred thousand.

Client 00:47:44
Got it. How do you see that growing over the next two to three years?

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Expert 00:47:49

I think it will be in the similar ballpark because for any other new use cases, now we are comfortable building our own agents. We know exactly the pipeline that is used. We know exactly the architecture that's been leveraged. We are able to create our own agents for our own use cases, so we could keep it internal now.

Client 00:48:09

How is the product priced for you? Is it based on number of workflows that you build? Is it based on number of agents that you use? How does it work?

Expert 00:48:21

Workflows.

Client 00:48:23

Got it. Can you help us understand how the pricing will work? Regardless of the number of specialized agents that you use in each workflow, one workflow is priced at a certain dollar value for the year. Is that how it is?

Expert 00:48:39

Okay. How would I say this? We have an enterprise contract with this particular one. The different dimension was provided to us, whether it's AI agents or number of employees that were using it, or having an active workflow use cases on this. The other one was given to us was workload volume and how many integrations were supporting this use case, whether it's one which is CRM or is it a combination of A, B, C, D, E.

We also looked at deployment model, whether it's only a SaaS deployment, whether do you want it private cloud or you had on-prem that we are managing it. These are different factors that were considered along with compliance requirement as well. We didn't have much on the compliance here, which was straightforward. These were all the different factors and dimensions that were considered for sizing.

Client 00:49:30

Got it. Maybe I'll just simplify my question. I understand SaaS versus private cloud. There'll be a difference in pricing. If it's based on number of workflows and number of integrations, then what I'm hearing is that the pricing is not consumption-based.

You decide that you have this workflow, and these are the number of workflows that you have live during the year and you pay for them, but it's not based on how much you use each workflow the number of agents that are called each time or the number of times a specialization is called. That does not seem to be a factor in your pricing. Is that the right understanding?

Expert 00:50:12

Right. Again, like I said, this was a subscription-based enterprise model pricing for us. Should I say Ema wanted this deal very much with us because they wanted to have a logo, if not publicly, but at least internally, they wanted to quote the world that a conglomerate is part of their and hence **they were okay with the pricing, tighter subscription plan for us for this particular sets of use cases**.

Client 00:50:37

You now expected to be in the similar ballpark and you mentioned few hundred thousand. Again, I don't know the exact number, so let's say $200,000-$300,000. I'm just assuming this. When you say similar ballpark, does this mean you see **it growing** 50%? Do you see it growing 100%? What is that number like?

Expert 00:51:03

5%, 10%?

Client 00:51:06

5%, 10%, got it. Is that because you don't plan to have many more workflows over the next two to three years?

Expert 00:51:14

Let's take it the other way. Instead of having workflows with Ema, we are comfortable building our workflows right now. We understand the pipeline. We can do it internally.

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Client 00:51:27
Understood. Is that something that has emerged as a consequence of using Ema, or is that just something independently that has happened over time where **you're more confident building these workflows**?

Expert 00:51:38
I think both. We've learned from Ema. We've got comfortable. Now we also come up with a strategy of, "Hey, you know what? We've understood. I think we'd have to take this to market at some point with other use cases that we have, with other domains that we are comfortable with. If that is the case, then why don't we start with an enterprise level, not only in manufacturing, but also getting to HR for internal purposes?" That is something that we are actively pursuing.

Client 00:52:08
Got it. How sticky is Ema as a product? If you had to replace Ema and introduce another player that would build these workflows for you or hypothetically build these workflows yourself, how difficult of an effort would that be? Are all these workflows, the way that you've configured it, stored inside Ema? Would you have to build all of them again?

Expert 00:52:32
Yeah, we have to build all of them again, but I don't think we would look at changing Ema for now because we like Ema for a reason. We have Ema for a reason, and I think what we couldn't see in other vendors, we saw in Ema and we intend to keep it.

Client 00:52:49
Got it. The reason I was asking this question and where it was coming from is that all of your incremental newer use cases, you said that you have an inclination to build it in house. In the future, do you also foresee migrating these four use cases in house instead of using Ema for it?

Expert 00:53:07
Good question, but I really don't know the answers for that. At least not in the near visibility.

Client 00:53:14
Got it. I just have one last question from my side. If you had to give Ema a score on 1-10, one being lowest and 10 being highest, what would that score be?

Expert 00:53:25
Score for what?

Client 00:53:27
Yeah, just overall feedback as an NPS.

Expert 00:53:31
Yeah. I think seven or eight is where I would put Ema.

Client 00:53:35
Got it. What would be aspects that Ema can do which will make it a 10 on 10 for you?

Expert 00:53:41
Good question. It's not a lightweight or a plug-and-play tool. I would want Ema to be a plug-and-play tool. It's a platform. It's a little heavier on the starting point. If you want to have a quick, narrow automation without ownership, then Ema may not be the choice. There are other open sources can let you do that. That's my first one.

Again, if you talk to somebody who is a fan of Ema, they would say, "Look, this is an enterprise-grade capability. You cannot achieve this

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with plug and play." What was the actual reason we went with Ema is also that it's an enterprise-grade platform, but that said, not everybody wants to have an enterprise-grade platform on their end. Some of them prefer a plug-and-play tool.

Client 00:54:28

Got it. Considering the preferences, this doesn't seem to be a detractor because it was exactly what you wanted?

Expert 00:54:36

Exactly, I'm exactly mentioning that I wanted an enterprise one, but I know a few friends in the other industry who does not want an enterprise-grade. They want a simple use tool that can solve a pain point to see whether it's the right fit or not instead of a platform. That is where it was biggest concern.

Client 00:54:56

Got it. If I were to rephrase the question, considering your requirement of wanting an enterprise-grade tool and in your usage of Ema, would you then give it a 10 on 10?

Expert 00:55:07

Absolutely.

Client 00:55:08

Got it. This has been very helpful. Thank you so much for your time. Have a good rest of your day.

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